Example Valley Children's Hospital

Financial Assistance Policy (Charity Care)

Effective date: July 1, 2025

1. Purpose

Example Valley Children's Hospital is committed to providing financial assistance to patients who are uninsured, underinsured, or otherwise unable to pay for emergency and other medically necessary care, consistent with Section 501(r) of the Internal Revenue Code and applicable Texas law.

2. Scope

This Policy applies to emergency and other medically necessary care provided by Example Valley Children's Hospital.

This Policy does not cover non-medically necessary services.

A list of providers who deliver care in the Hospital, showing which providers are and are not covered by this Policy, is in Attachment 1 of this Policy.

3. Definitions

3.1 Household. For purposes of this Policy, the household includes the patient's parents or legal guardians and all children under 18 living in the same home.

3.2 Income. Household income means the household's total gross annual income before taxes and deductions.

3.3 Federal Poverty Guidelines (FPG). Eligibility is determined using the Federal Poverty Guidelines in effect on the date of service.

3.4 Medically necessary care. Care that is reasonable and necessary to diagnose or treat an illness or injury, as determined by the treating provider.

4. Eligibility for Financial Assistance

4.1 Patients may qualify for financial assistance if household income is at or below 400% of the FPG and the other conditions of this Policy are met.

Patients with household income at or below 300% of the Federal Poverty Guidelines qualify for free care, a 100% discount.

Patients with household income above 300% and at or below 400% of the Federal Poverty Guidelines will not be charged more than amounts generally billed.

5. Other Eligibility Conditions

5.1 Assets. The Hospital does not consider assets when determining eligibility.

5.2 Residency. Patients must be residents of the State of Texas. The residency requirement does not apply to emergency care.

5.3 Insurance. Insured patients are eligible for assistance with deductibles, co-insurance and other balances after insurance.

5.4 Other programs. Patients are not required to apply for Medicaid before receiving a financial assistance determination.

6. How to Apply

6.1 Application period. Patients may apply at any time within 240 days after the date of the first post-discharge billing statement.

6.2 Required documents. Applicants must attach the following documents:

(a) pay stubs for the last 30 days for each parent or guardian;

(b) proof of Texas residency such as a utility bill or lease;

6.3 Where to apply. Completed applications may be submitted:

- By mail to Patient Financial Services, 2100 Example Children's Way, McAllen, TX 78503.

- In person at Admitting Office, main lobby.

- By telephone at (956) 555-0300.

6.4 Determination. The Hospital will notify the patient in writing of its determination and the basis for the determination.

6.5 Award period. Approved financial assistance applies to eligible care for 12 months from the date of determination.

7. Billing and Collections

7.1 Amounts generally billed (AGB). The Hospital calculates amounts generally billed using the look-back method based on Medicaid, together with Medicare fee-for-service and private health insurers. The current AGB percentage is 24% of gross charges.

7.2 Presumptive eligibility. The Hospital grants presumptive eligibility for free care, without an application, to patients who are enrolled in CHIP or Medicaid in the prior 12 months or eligible for free school lunch.

7.3 Screening. The Hospital screens patients for financial assistance before issuing the first billing statement.

7.4 Refunds. Any payment above the amount owed after assistance is applied will be refunded to the guarantor.

7.5 Collections. The Hospital will not engage in extraordinary collection actions before making reasonable efforts to determine whether a patient is eligible for financial assistance. The Billing and Collections Policy is available free of charge.

Questions: call (956) 555-0300 or write to Patient Financial Services, 2100 Example Children's Way, McAllen, TX 78503.